VERIDIAN PHARMA LTD. — Quality & Compliance Directorate, Hyderabad Facility

Standard Operating Procedure: Deviation Reporting and Management

Document ID: SOP-QA-014	**Version:** 2.0	**Effective Date:** 2026-09-01
Owner: Meera Rao (QA Head)	**Department:** Quality Assurance	**Status:** Effective

1. Purpose

This standard operating procedure establishes updated and rigorous protocols for recognizing, reporting, evaluating, and managing unexpected deviations across all cGMP operations conducted by Veridian Pharma Ltd. at the Hyderabad facility.

The revised protocol refines escalation pathways, harmonizes investigation classification thresholds, and enforces direct executive communication for critical compliance vulnerabilities, thereby strengthening our Quality Management System (QMS).

It is designed to satisfy the rigorous audit benchmarks of global health regulatory bodies, including FDA, EMA, and CDSCO, ensuring that every unexpected event is thoroughly investigated with scientific rigor.

2. Scope

This procedure governs all manufacturing sectors, quality control analytical and microbiological testing, warehouse storage, facilities management, validation teams, and automated IT systems at the Hyderabad site.

The scope applies to all deviations, whether categorized as minor, major, or critical, that impact product quality, safety, identity, strength, purity, or data governance.

This document replaces and supersedes all prior guidelines regarding deviation reporting within the facility.

3. Responsibilities

• **Initiator (Operational Staff):** Immediately halt non-conforming operations, secure and quarantine suspect product or equipment, document the immediate facts, and initiate digital notification.

• **Functional Department Head:** Direct initial containment actions, allocate departmental engineering or analytical resources for root cause investigation, and approve proposed CAPAs.

• **QA Head (Meera Rao):** Provide direct oversight on critical events, receive immediate telephone alerts, evaluate high-risk manufacturing impacts, and issue final formal closure approvals.

• **Quality Assurance Compliance Team:** Oversee QMS entry processing, verify categorization criteria, maintain the central tracker, coordinate cross-functional investigation panels, and review CAPA effectiveness.

4. Procedure

4.1 Event Identification and Immediate Containment: Operational personnel must promptly document any event departing from validated parameters or approved batch manufacturing instructions during shift execution.

4.2 Physical and Electronic Quarantine: Containment steps must be executed to prevent contamination, cross-mix, or further processing of suspect material by applying physical quarantine labels and electronic holds in the ERP system.

4.3 Standard Reporting Window: Reporting window is 48 hours.

4.4 Immediate Telephonic Escalation: Critical deviations also need a phone call to QA Head Meera Rao immediately.

4.5 Digital QMS Entry Submission: The initiator logs into the digital QMS platform and submits the standardized deviation entry with comprehensive event descriptions and initial environmental readings.

4.6 Managerial Shift Verification: The department manager reviews the event summary and verifies immediate containment measures within the shift to confirm that uninspected lots are safely segregated.

4.7 Cross-Functional Regulatory Assessment: QA conducts an impact assessment concerning batch release and regulatory notification requirements in parallel with ongoing technical inquiries.

4.8 Systematic Root Cause Analysis: Root cause analysis is conducted utilizing standard five-whys or fishbone methodology to distinguish superficial symptoms from true systemic root causes.

4.9 Formulation of Targeted CAPA: Corrective and preventive actions (CAPA) are formulated and assigned to responsible owners with clear milestones and effectiveness verification criteria.

4.10 Batch Disposition and Closure Authorization: Quality Assurance evaluates the totality of technical evidence before making a binding batch disposition recommendation, ensuring that no compromised lot is released.

4.11 Supersedure Note: Supersedes v1.

5. Records and Documentation

All deviation workflows, telephonic escalation logs, investigation dossiers, expert reports, and CAPA effectiveness checks must be permanently preserved within the electronic QMS repository.

Hardcopy containment tags and physical inspection checklists shall be filed in the specific batch production record package.

6. Revision History

Version	Effective Date	Change Description
1.0	2026-03-10	Initial release.
2.0	2026-09-01	Extended reporting window to 48 hours and introduced mandatory immediate phone escalation to QA Head for critical deviations. Supersedes v1.